GAMSA · Gender-Affirming Medicines South Australia

Blood test record

Any hormone medicine · gamsa.au/monitoring

Key points Write down each result with its units, and when you took your last dose.

Most aims are for a sample taken just before the next dose; the table shows the exceptions. Ask for the timing to be written on the pathology form.

Usual aims (ask your prescriber which apply to you)

Test	When the sample is taken	Usual aim
Oestradiol, tablets	Just before the next tablet	Above about 250 pmol/L
Oestradiol, patches	Just before a new patch	Above about 250 pmol/L
Oestradiol, gel	Before the day's gel, from the other arm	Above about 250 pmol/L
Oestradiol, implants	About every 3 months in the first year	Above about 250 pmol/L
Testosterone (on oestradiol)	At each review	Below 2 nmol/L if full suppression is wanted
Testosterone, long-acting injection	Just before the next injection	About 10 to 20 nmol/L
Testosterone, short-acting injection	Midway between injections	Within the male range
Testosterone, Testogel	Morning, before the day's gel	About 10 to 20 nmol/L
Testosterone, Testavan	2 to 4 hours after the gel	17.3 to 36.4 nmol/L
Testosterone, cream	Morning, before the day's cream	About 10 to 20 nmol/L
Haematocrit on testosterone	At each review	Below 0.50 L/L (50%)

Good to know

- Gel on the skin where the blood is taken can make a result look far too high. Ask for the sample from the arm you did not put gel on.
- High-dose biotin (in some hair, skin and nail supplements) can make some oestradiol results read falsely high. Tell the collection centre if you take it.
- Lab reports mark results as high or low using the sex on your Medicare or lab record. Your prescriber reads them against the range that fits your body on hormones.
- A flagged result is a reason to talk with your prescriber, not to change a dose on your own.

Based on gamsa.au: Blood tests and monitoring (AusPATH Australian Standards of Care 2026, and each product's Australian product information).

Prepared by Theodore South, BPharm (Hons), registered pharmacist
gamsa.au · Questions or corrections: gamsaenquiries@gmail.com
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Date	Sample at time	Last dose date, time	Test e.g. oestradiol	Result with units	My target	Change made

Units: oestradiol is usually reported in pmol/L and testosterone in nmol/L. Your prescriber reads the result with you.

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